

Orca Conservation

Orcas face several human-caused threats. Chemical pollutants such as PCBs accumulate in their blubber and impair reproduction and immune function.

Prey depletion is a major threat to fish-eating resident orcas. Declines in Chinook salmon reduce the food available to Southern Resident killer whales.

Underwater noise from ships interferes with echolocation and communication, making it harder for orcas to hunt and coordinate.

The Southern Resident population of the northeastern Pacific is listed as endangered, with only around seventy individuals remaining.